

The history of Indian politics is rich, complex, and deeply rooted in the country's struggle for independence and its evolution as a democratic nation. Before independence in 1947, India was under British colonial rule for nearly two centuries. Political movements during this period were primarily focused on achieving freedom from British control. The Indian National Congress (INC), founded in 1885, became the leading force in the freedom struggle. Leaders like Mahatma Gandhi, Jawaharlal Nehru, and Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel played crucial roles in mobilizing the masses through non-violent movements such as the Non-Cooperation Movement, Civil Disobedience Movement, and Quit India Movement. Alongside the Congress, other political groups like the Muslim League, led by Muhammad Ali Jinnah, also gained prominence. The demand for a separate nation for Muslims eventually led to the partition of India and the creation of Pakistan in 1947. After independence, India adopted a democratic system of governance and became a republic in 1950 with the implementation of its Constitution. The early decades of Indian politics were dominated by the Congress party, with Jawaharlal Nehru serving as the first Prime Minister and laying the foundation for a secular and socialist-oriented state.

In the later decades, Indian politics saw the rise of regional parties and coalition governments. The dominance of the Congress party began to decline after the 1960s and 1970s. The Emergency period (1975–1977), declared by Prime Minister Indira Gandhi, remains one of the most controversial phases in Indian political history. The 1980s and 1990s witnessed significant political changes, including economic liberalization in 1991 under Prime Minister P.V. Narasimha Rao and Finance Minister Dr. Manmohan Singh. This marked a shift from a state-controlled economy to a more market-oriented approach. The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) emerged as a major political force in the 1990s and has since played a key role in national politics. Coalition governments became common, reflecting India's diverse political landscape. In recent years, Indian politics has been characterized by strong leadership, increased use of technology in campaigns, and greater public participation. Issues such as economic development, national security, social justice, and governance continue to shape political discourse. Overall, Indian politics reflects the diversity, challenges, and aspirations of one of the world's largest democracies.